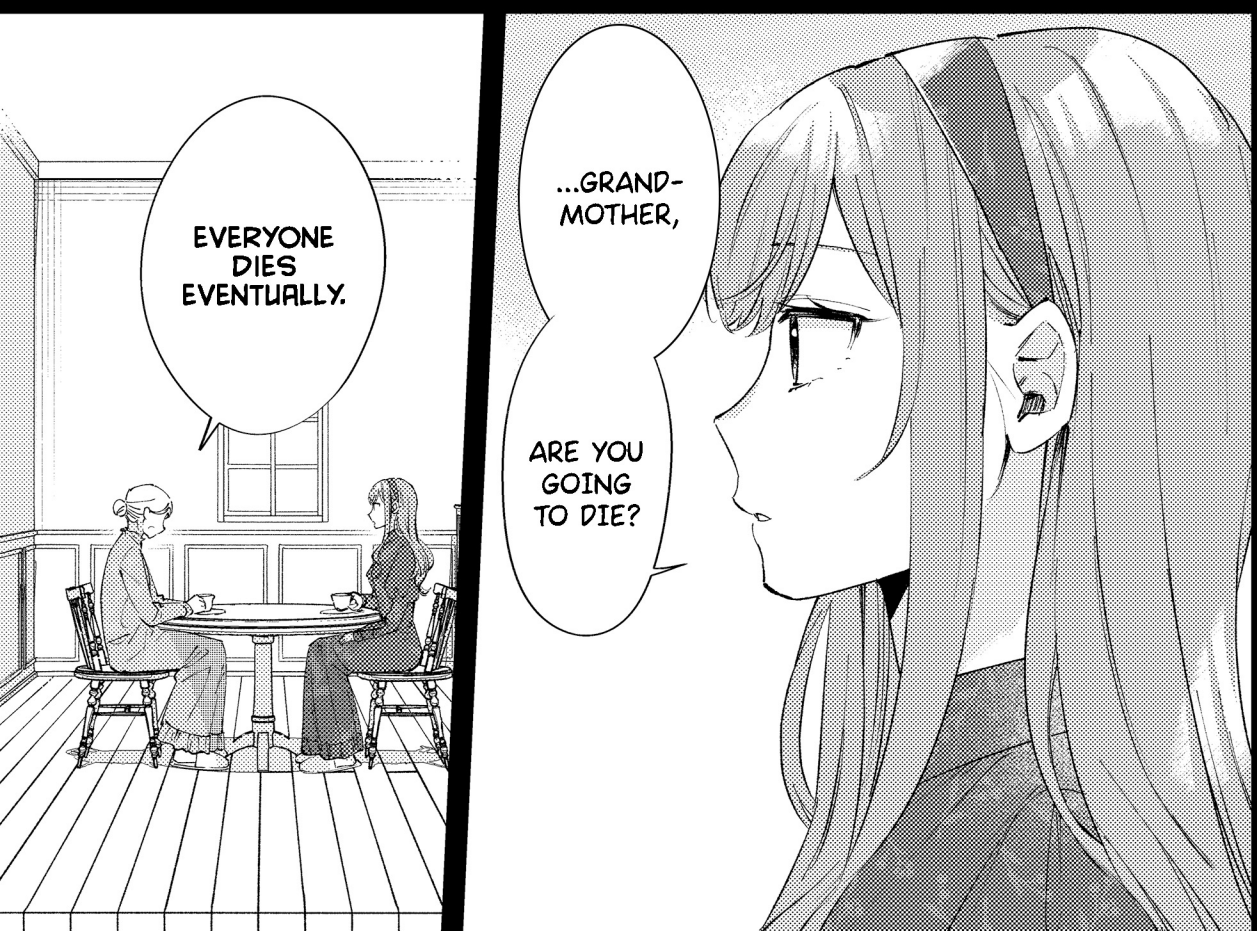
Afternoon Tea for Two
Shall we have afternoo
MEI FUJIMATSU
HARU SATSUKI

MITSURUKO,
WAS MY GRAND-MOTHER.
THE ONE WHO TAUGHT ME HOW TO BREW TEA...

IF I WERE TO DIE, WHO WOULD YOU DRINK TEA WITH?


EVERYONE DIES EVENTUALLY.
...GRAND-MOTHER,
ARE YOU GOING TO DIE?

MY MOTHER WAS ALWAYS BUSY, SO WE ONLY HAD TEA TOGETHER...
A HANDFUL OF TIMES.
YOU MUST FIND SOMEONE YOU CAN SHARE TEA WITH.
I THOUGHT HAVING MY GRANDMOTHER ALONE WAS ENOUGH.
SO, FOR THE FIRST TIME, I TRIED SPEAKING TO A CLASSMATE.
WOULD YOU HAVE TEA WITH ME?

OF COURSE.
LET'S HAVE TEA, MITSURUKO.
SOON, THE NUMBER OF PEOPLE I COULD SHARE TEA WITH INCREASED.

BUT AFTER COMING HERE, I REMEMBERED-
DRINKING TEA ALONE IS...
...LONELY.
WHAT IF...
THE PERSON WHO COMES TO THIS HOUSE
DOESN'T LIKE TEA?

...I DON'T WANT TO FORCE IT ON THEM.
CLACK

JINGLE
JINGLE
WELCOME!

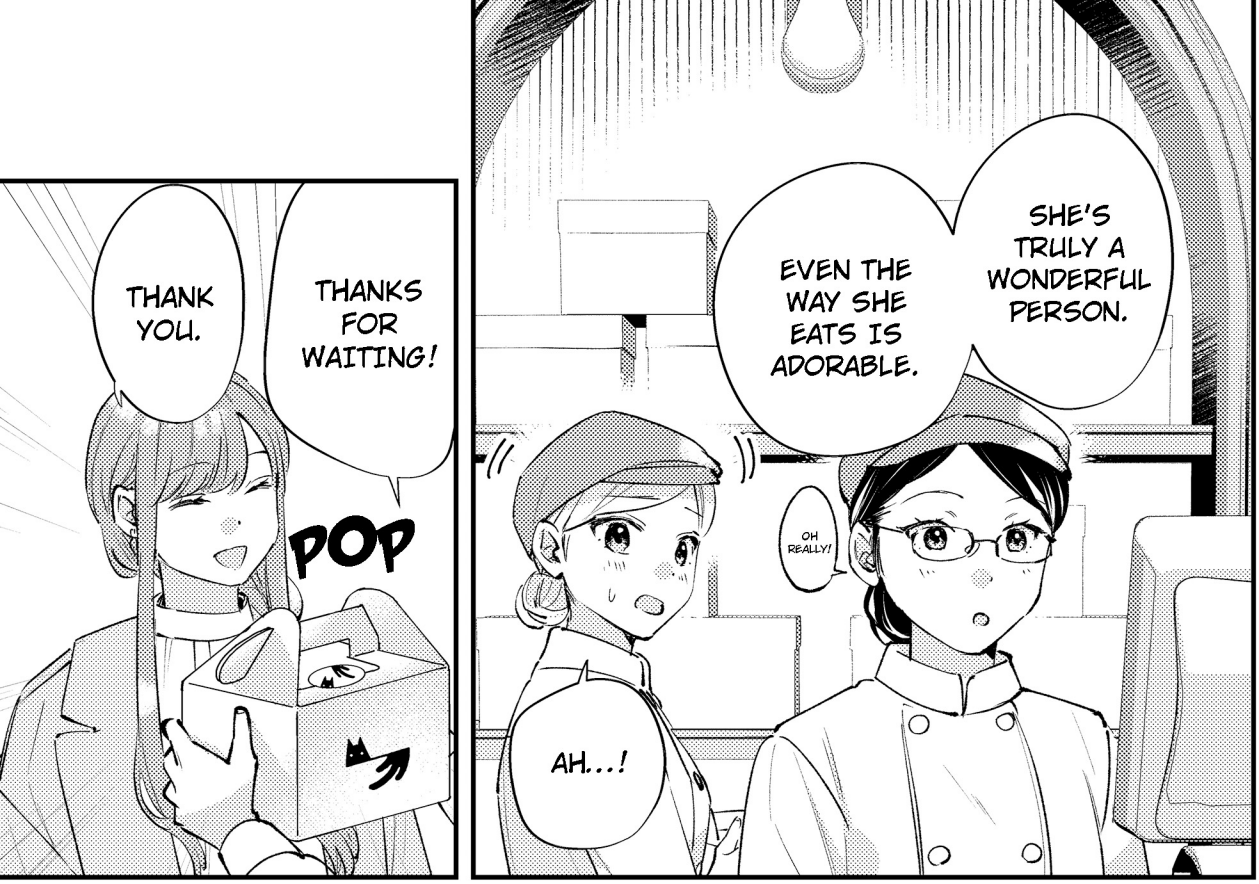
!?
AH-
MITSURUKO!
RITSU.
Patisserie Lily
THIS IS MY HOUSE-MATE-
SERIZAWA RITSU'S
WONDERFUL WORKPLACE.

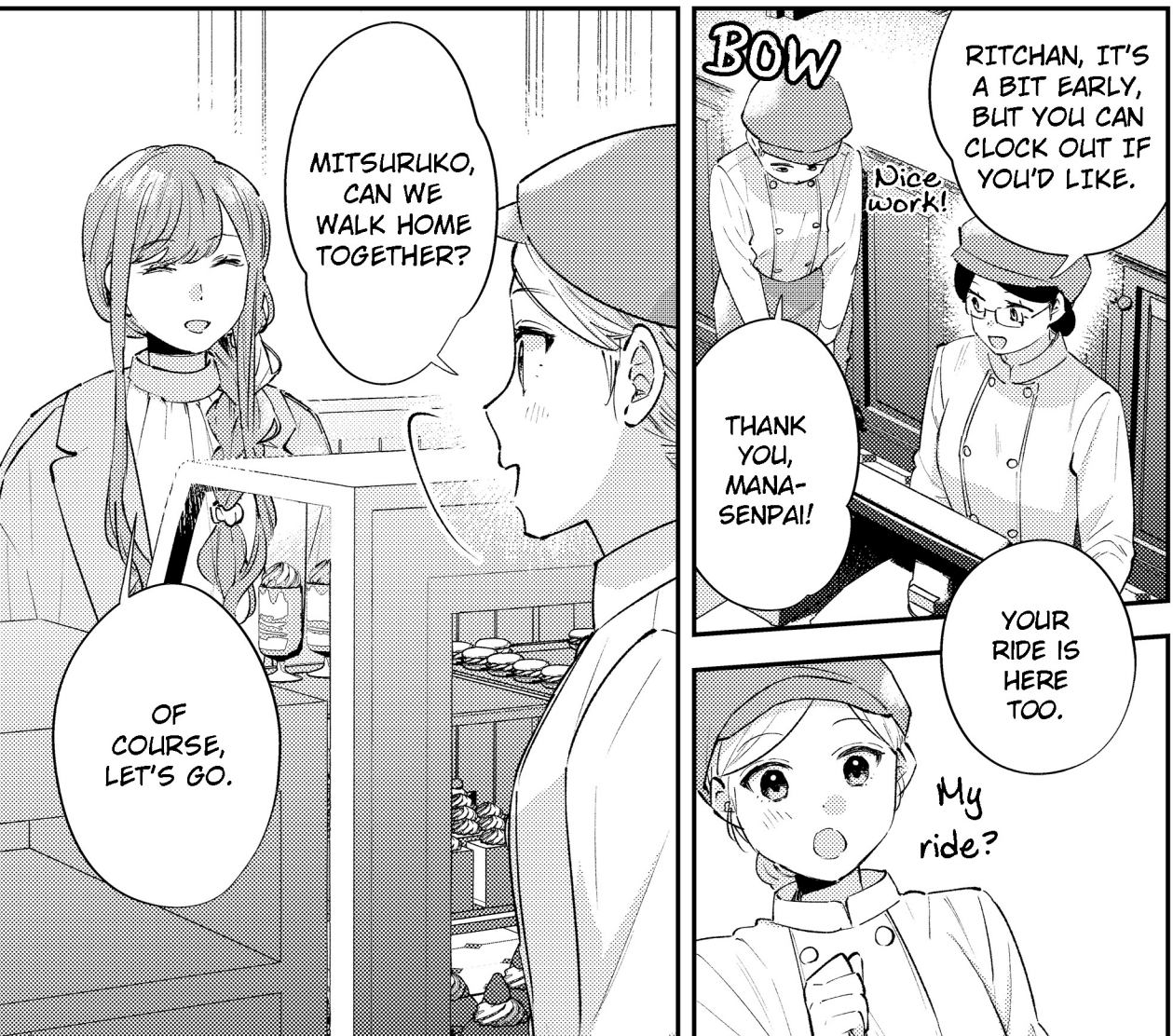
THEN I'LL TAKE TWO.
COMING RIGHT UP!

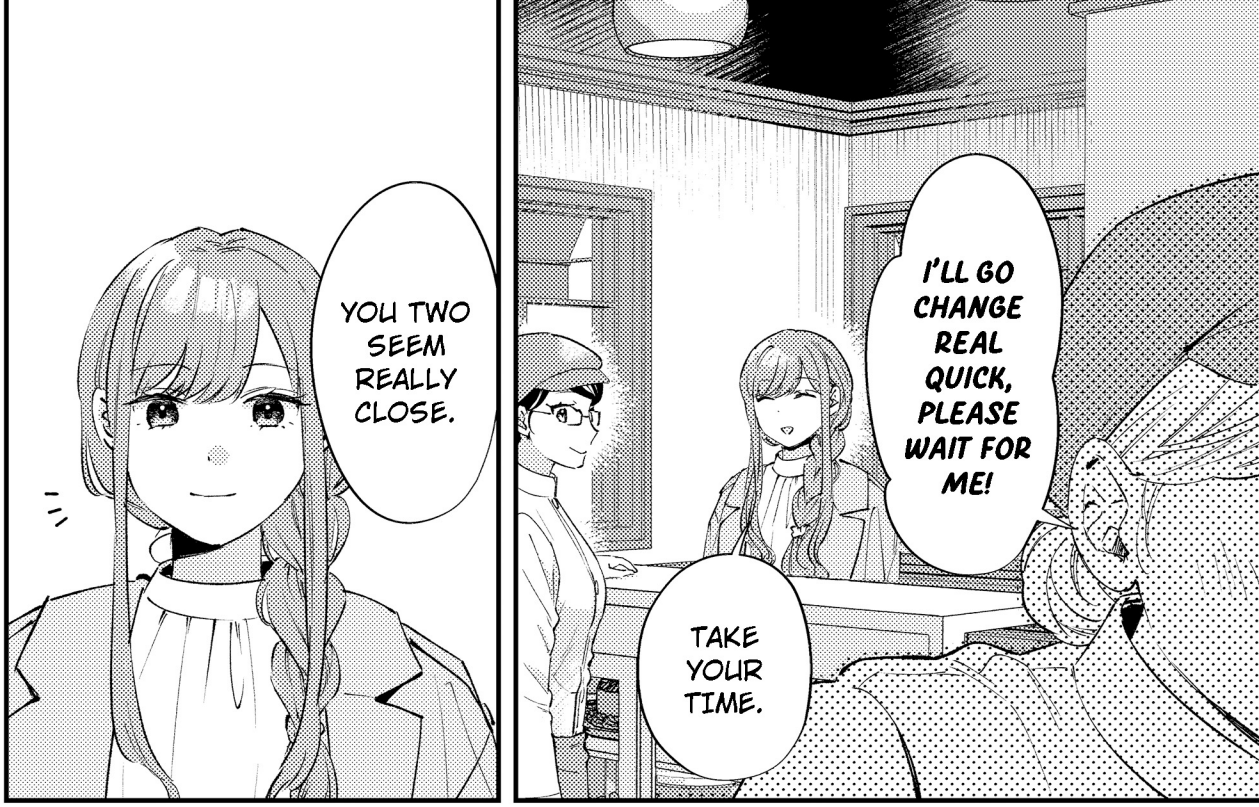
TODAY'S RECOMMENDATION IS THIS!
MELON TART
☆
MELON TART
480 YEN

TEA TASTES EVEN BETTER WHEN YOU SHARE IT WITH SOMEONE.
AND RITSU ALWAYS KEEPS ME COMPANY...

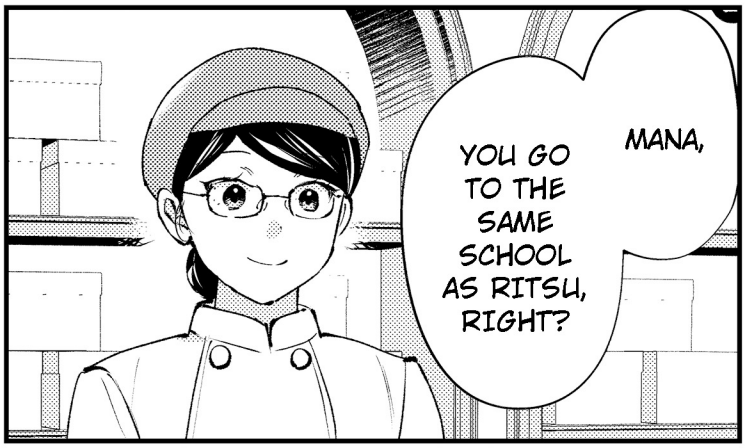
MITSURUKO,
ARE YOU EATING WITH RITCHAN AGAIN TODAY?
YES


SHE'S TRULY A WONDERFUL PERSON.
EVEN THE WAY SHE EATS IS ADORABLE.
OH REALLY!
AH...!
THANKS FOR WAITING!
POP
THANK YOU.

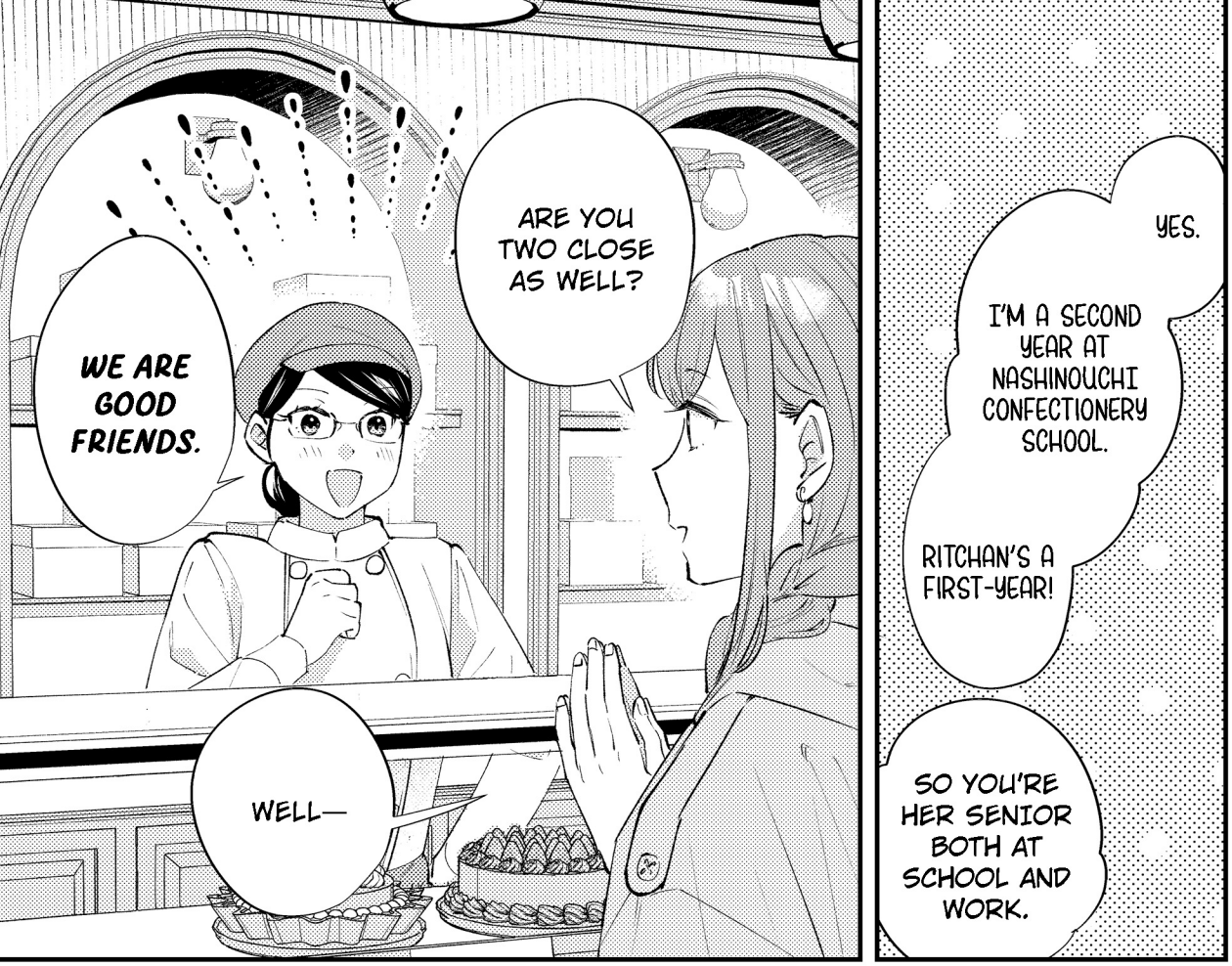

RITCHAN, IT'S A BIT EARLY, BUT YOU CAN CLOCK OUT IF YOU'D LIKE.
BOW
Nice work!
THANK YOU, MANA-SENPAI!
YOUR RIDE IS HERE TOO.
My ride?
MITSURUKO, CAN WE WALK HOME TOGETHER?
OF COURSE, LET'S GO.


YOU TWO SEEM REALLY CLOSE.
I'LL GO CHANGE REAL QUICK, PLEASE WAIT FOR ME!
TAKE YOUR TIME.

HUH— AREN'T YOU?
DO WE?
NO,


MANA, YOU GO TO THE SAME SCHOOL AS RITSU, RIGHT?

OH!
WE ARE. WE'RE CLOSE.



YES.

I'M A SECOND YEAR AT NASHINOUCHI CONFECTIONERY SCHOOL.

RITCHAN'S A FIRST-YEAR!

SO YOU'RE HER SENIOR BOTH AT SCHOOL AND WORK.

WE WENT RIVER FISHING RECENTLY.

RIVER FISHING!?

WOW!

ON DAYS OFF, RITCHAN SOMETIMES GATHERS A GROUP OF FRIENDS.

AND INVITES ME TO GO HIKING OR JUST HANG OUT.

SO THAT'S WHAT SHE'S BEEN DOING...

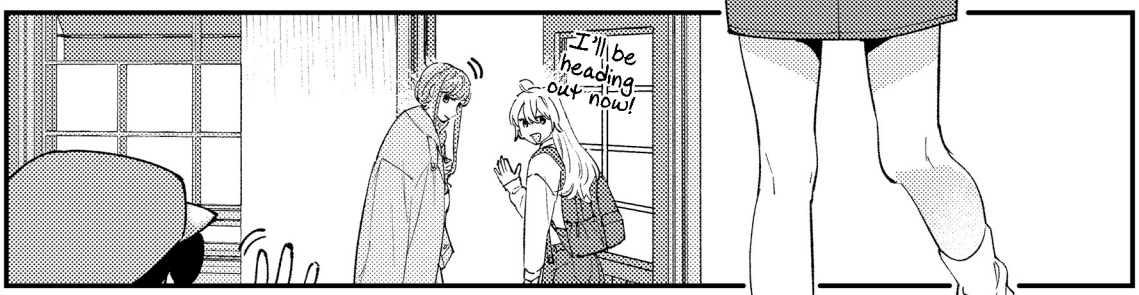
...WHEN SHE GOES OUT ON HER DAYS OFF.

YES. RITCHAN'S ACTUALLY VERY ACTIVE,

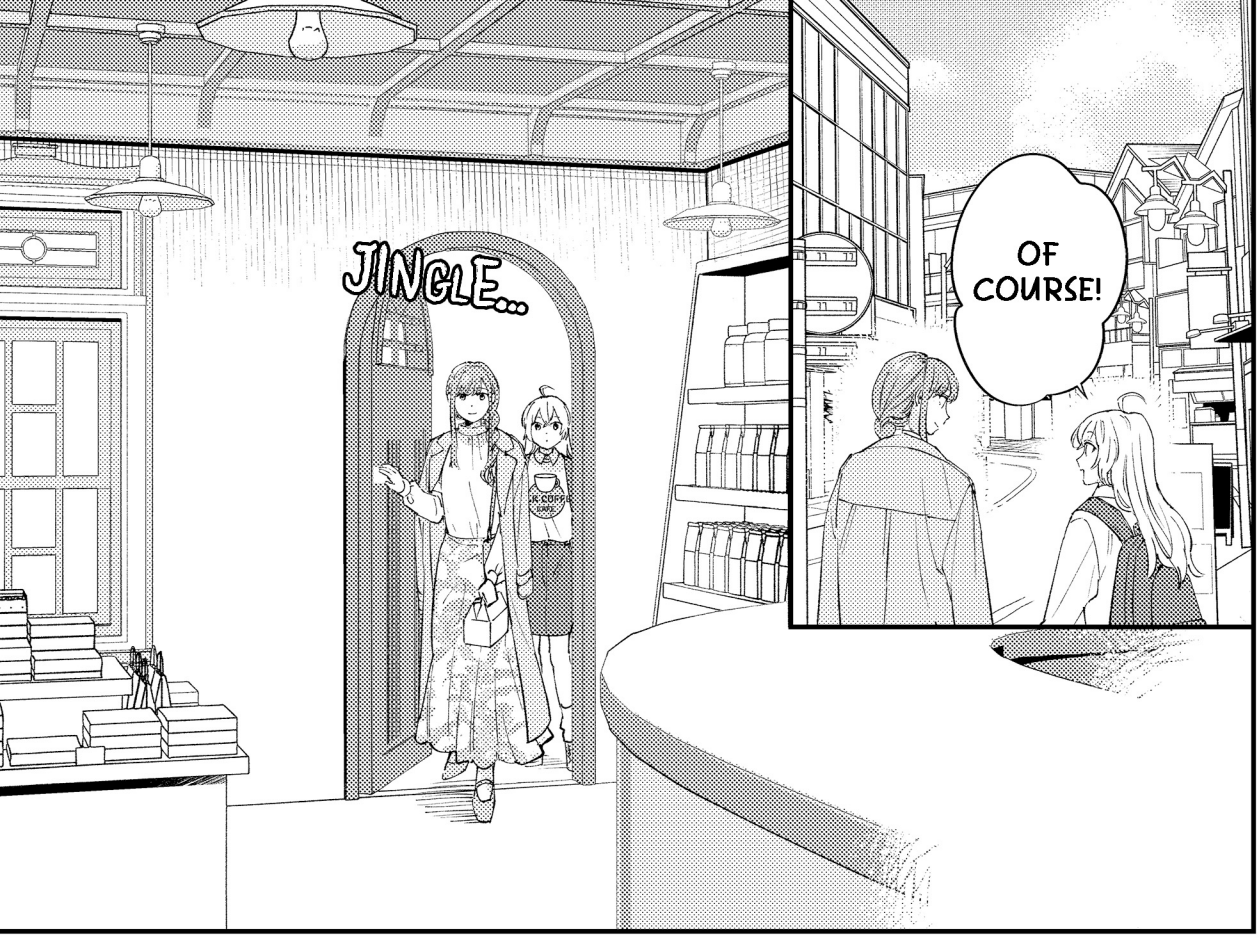
BRIGHT, AND REALLY POPULAR.

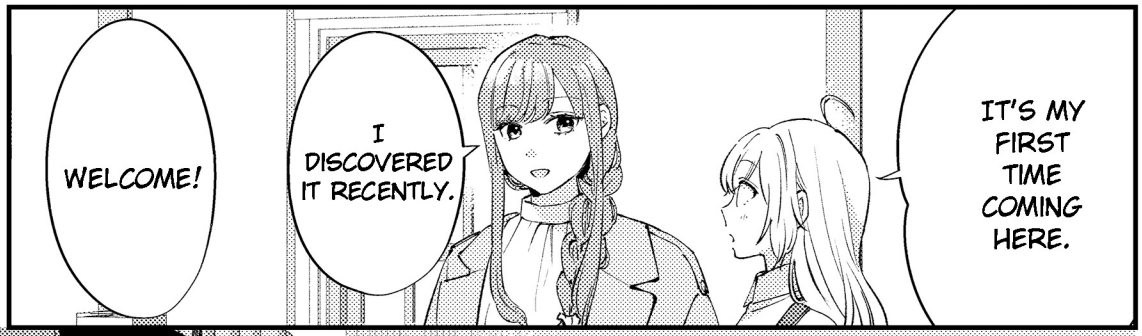
POPULAR... I THOUGHT SO.

MANA,
THANK YOU FOR CHATTING WITH ME.
I'M USUALLY FREE AROUND THIS TIME,
SO LET'S TALK AGAIN SOMETIME!
SORRY TO KEEP YOU WAITING!
MITSURUKO!
CAFE

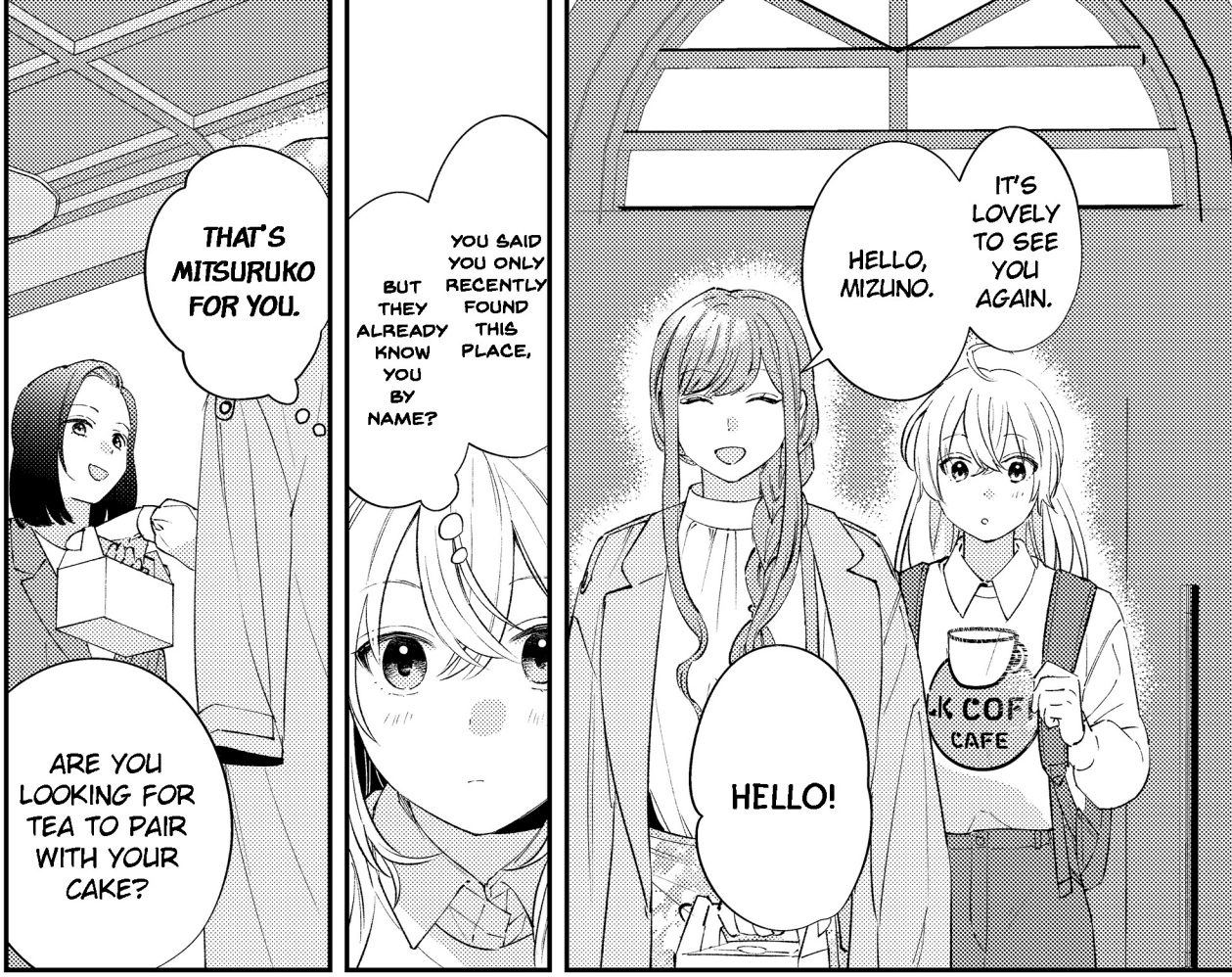

I'll be heading out now!

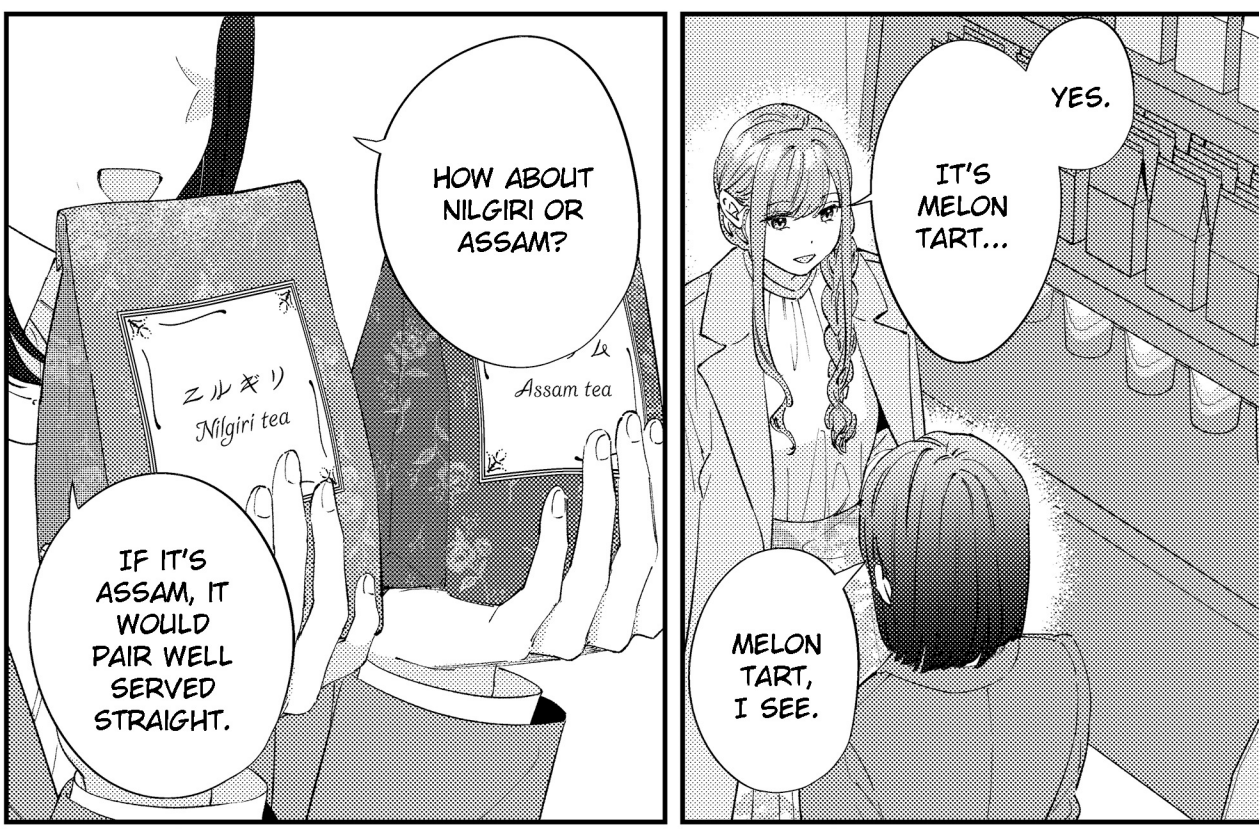
RITSU,
SHALL WE STOP BY A TEA SHOP?

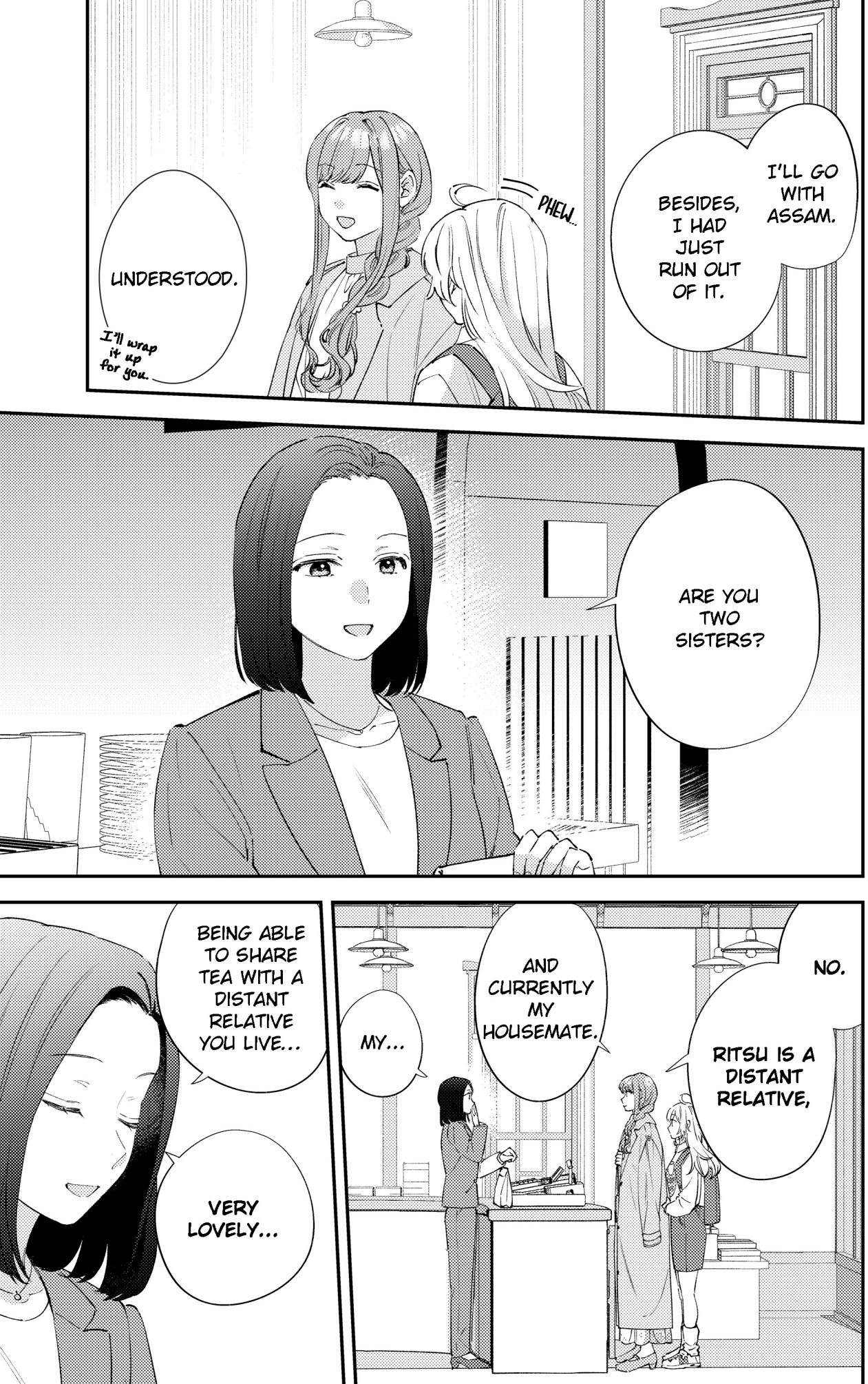

JINGLE...
OF COURSE!


WELCOME!
I DISCOVERED IT RECENTLY.
IT'S MY FIRST TIME COMING HERE.

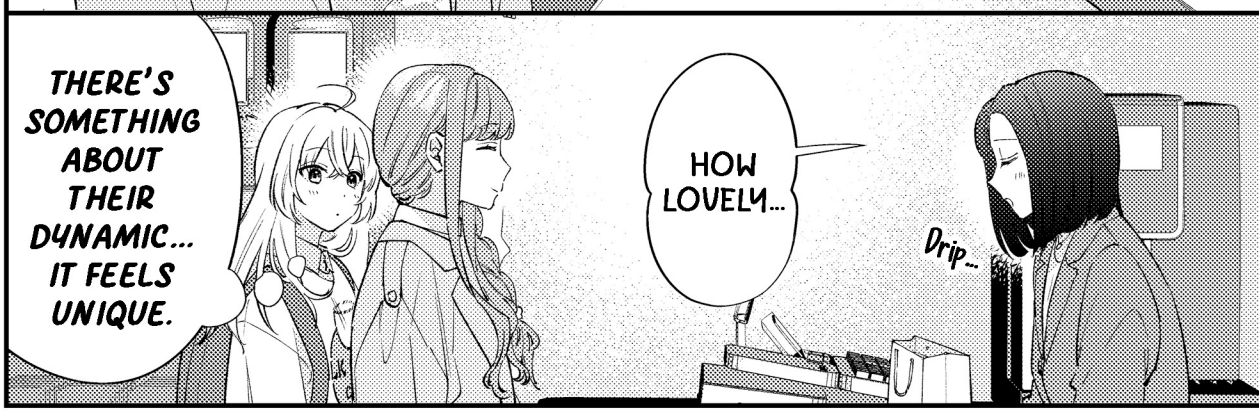
AH... MITSURUKO!


HELLO, MIZUNO.
IT'S LOVELY TO SEE YOU AGAIN.
HELLO!
CAFE
YOU SAID YOU ONLY RECENTLY FOUND THIS PLACE,
BUT THEY ALREADY KNOW YOU BY NAME?
THAT'S MITSURUKO FOR YOU.
ARE YOU LOOKING FOR TEA TO PAIR WITH YOUR CAKE?

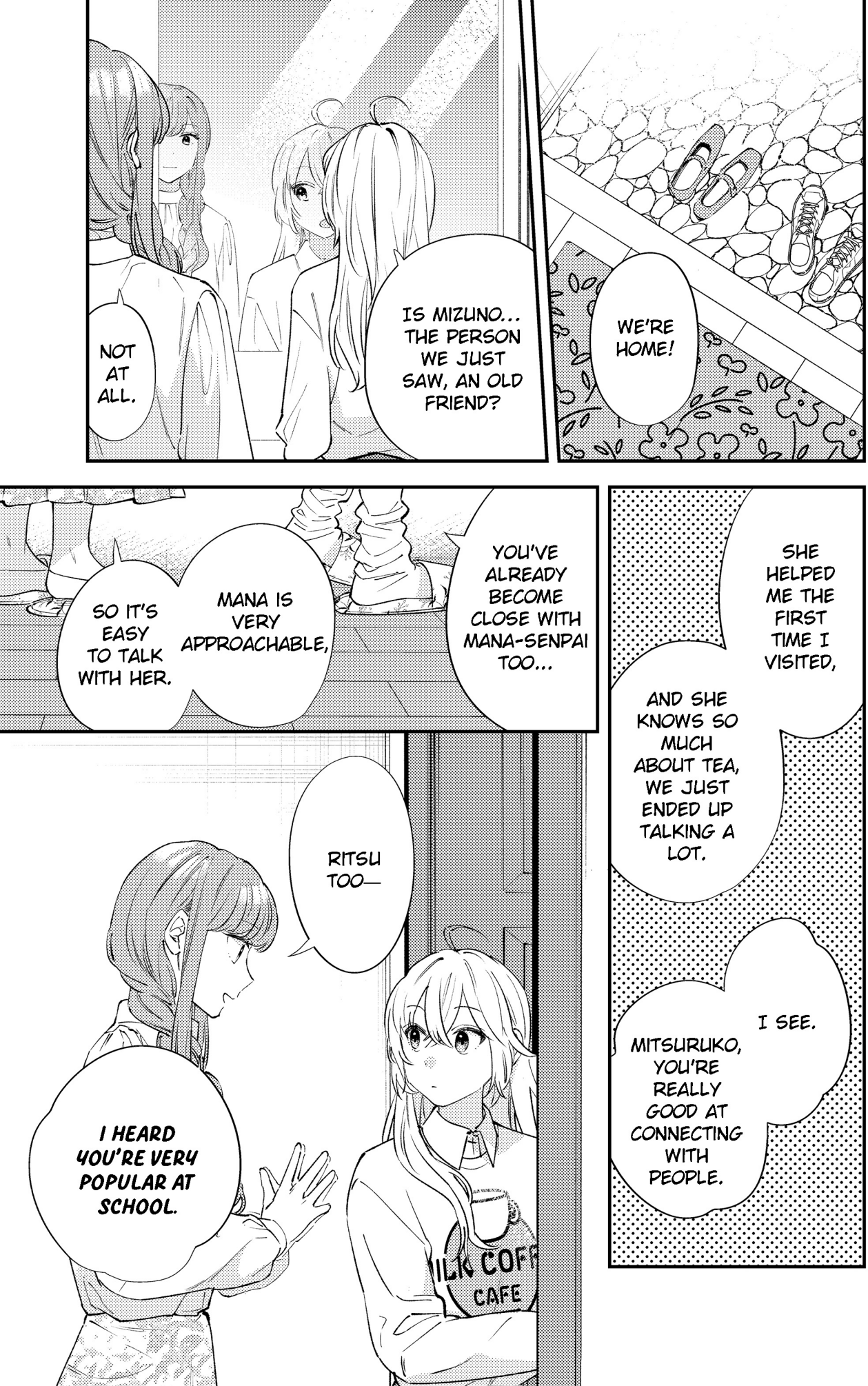

YES.
IT'S MELON TART...
MELON TART, I SEE.
HOW ABOUT NILGIRI OR ASSAM?
ニルギリ
Nilgiri tea
Assam tea
IF IT'S ASSAM, IT WOULD PAIR WELL SERVED STRAIGHT.

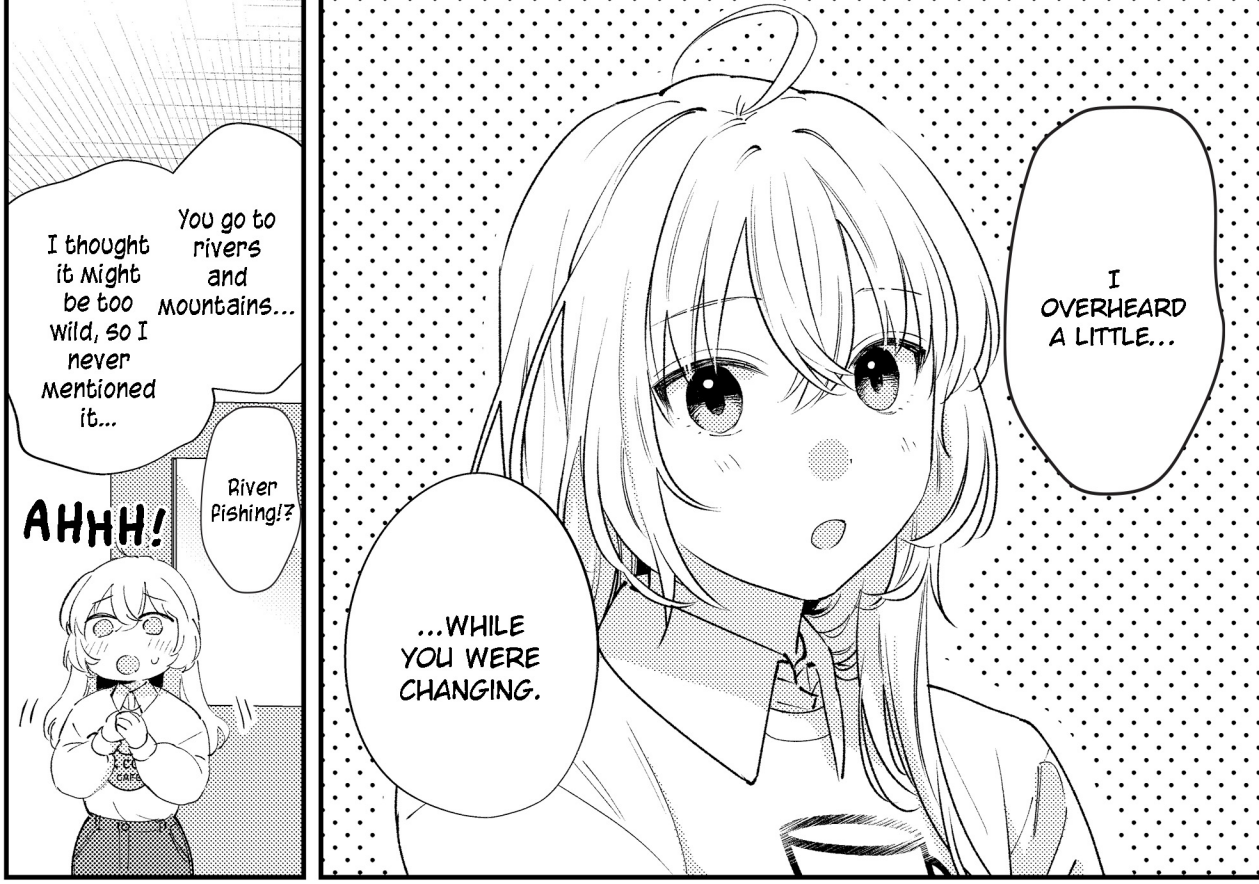

I'LL GO WITH ASSAM.
BESIDES, I HAD JUST RUN OUT OF IT.
PHEW...
UNDERSTOOD.
I'll wrap it up for you.
ARE YOU TWO SISTERS?
NO.
RITSU IS A DISTANT RELATIVE,
AND CURRENTLY MY HOUSEMATE.
MY...
BEING ABLE TO SHARE TEA WITH A DISTANT RELATIVE YOU LIVE...
VERY LOVELY...

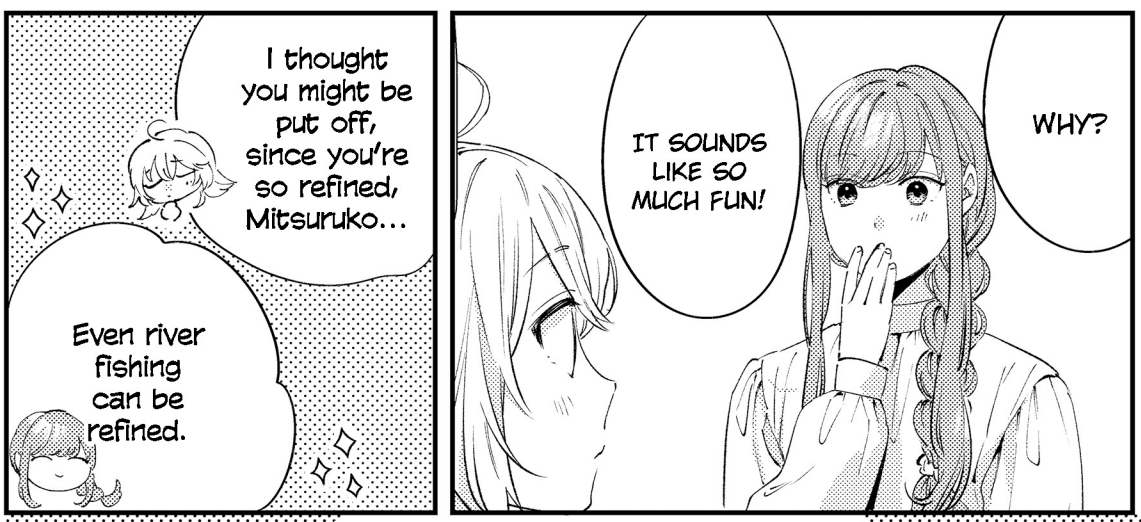
DRINKING TEA ALONE FEELS LONELY,
SO RITSU IS MY SAVIOR.
YES.
IT TRULY IS.

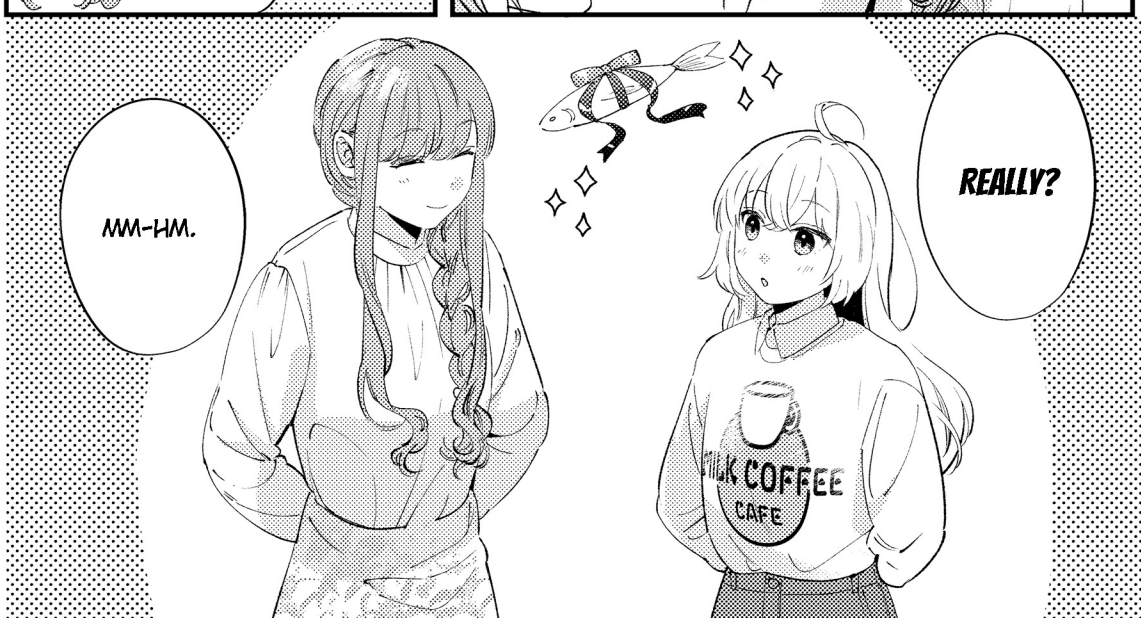

THERE'S SOMETHING ABOUT THEIR DYNAMIC... IT FEELS UNIQUE.
HOW LOVELY...
Drip...

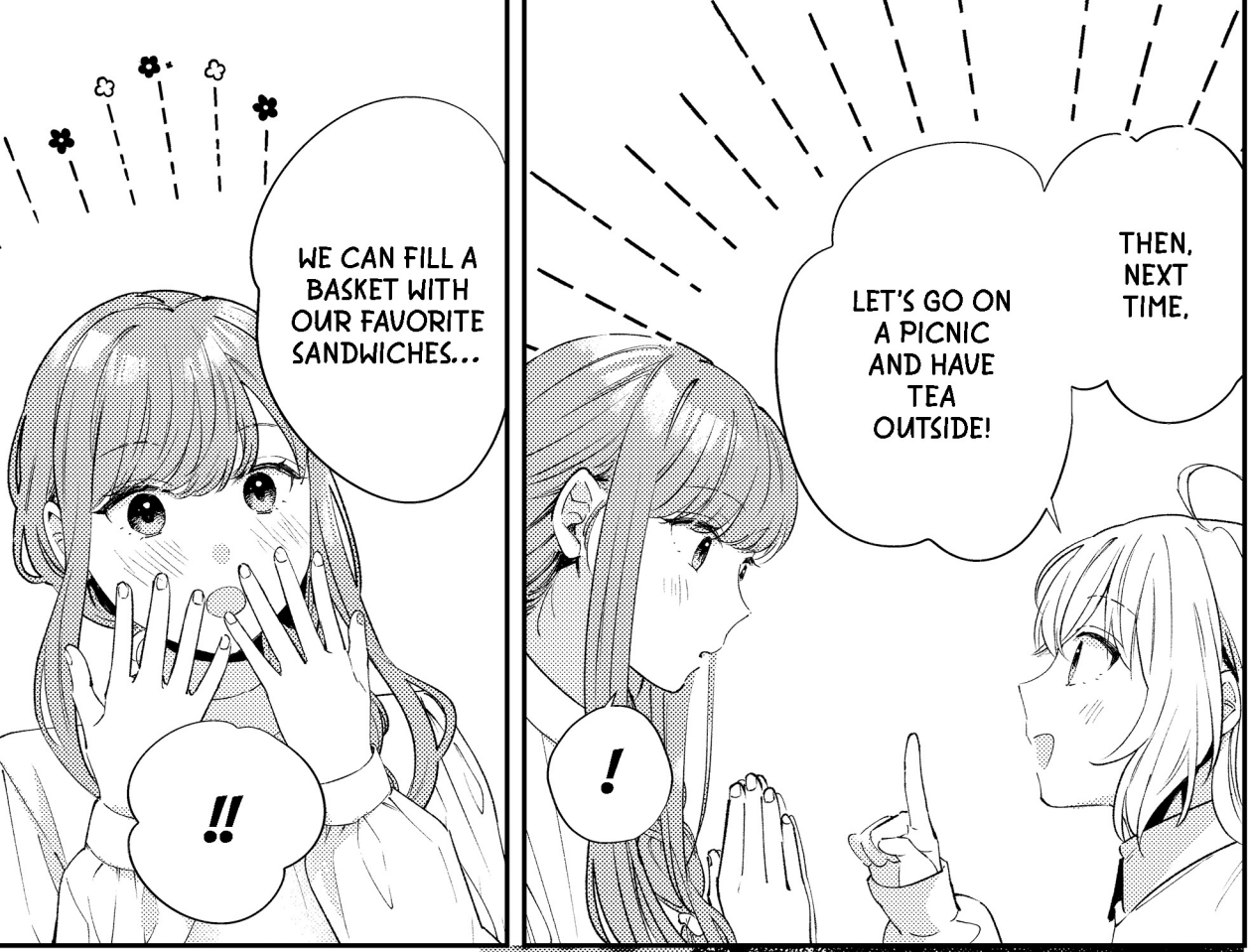
PLEASE DO VISIT AGAIN.
MITSURUKO,
RITSU,


NOT AT ALL.
IS MIZUNO... THE PERSON WE JUST SAW, AN OLD FRIEND?
WE'RE HOME!
SHE HELPED ME THE FIRST TIME I VISITED,
AND SHE KNOWS SO MUCH ABOUT TEA, WE JUST ENDED UP TALKING A LOT.
I SEE.
MITSURUKO, YOU'RE REALLY GOOD AT CONNECTING WITH PEOPLE.
YOU'VE ALREADY BECOME CLOSE WITH MANA-SENPAI TOO...
MANA IS VERY APPROACHABLE,
SO IT'S EASY TO TALK WITH HER.
RITSU TOO—
I HEARD YOU'RE VERY POPULAR AT SCHOOL.
CAFE


I OVERHEARD A LITTLE...
...WHILE YOU WERE CHANGING.
You go to rivers and mountains...
I thought it might be too wild, so I never mentioned it...
AHHH!
River fishing!?

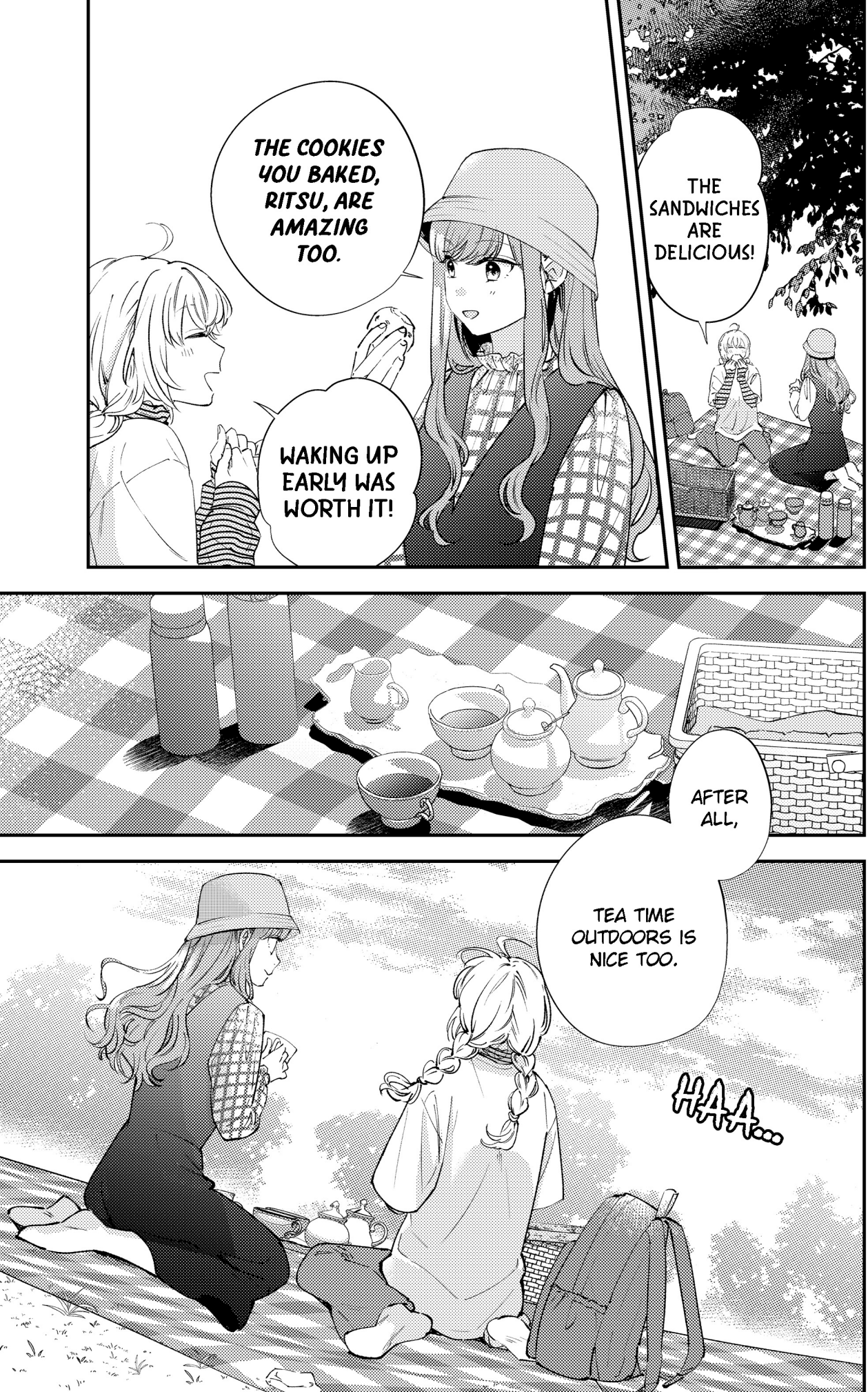

I thought you might be put off, since you're so refined, Mitsuruko...
Even river fishing can be refined.
IT SOUNDS LIKE SO MUCH FUN!
WHY?

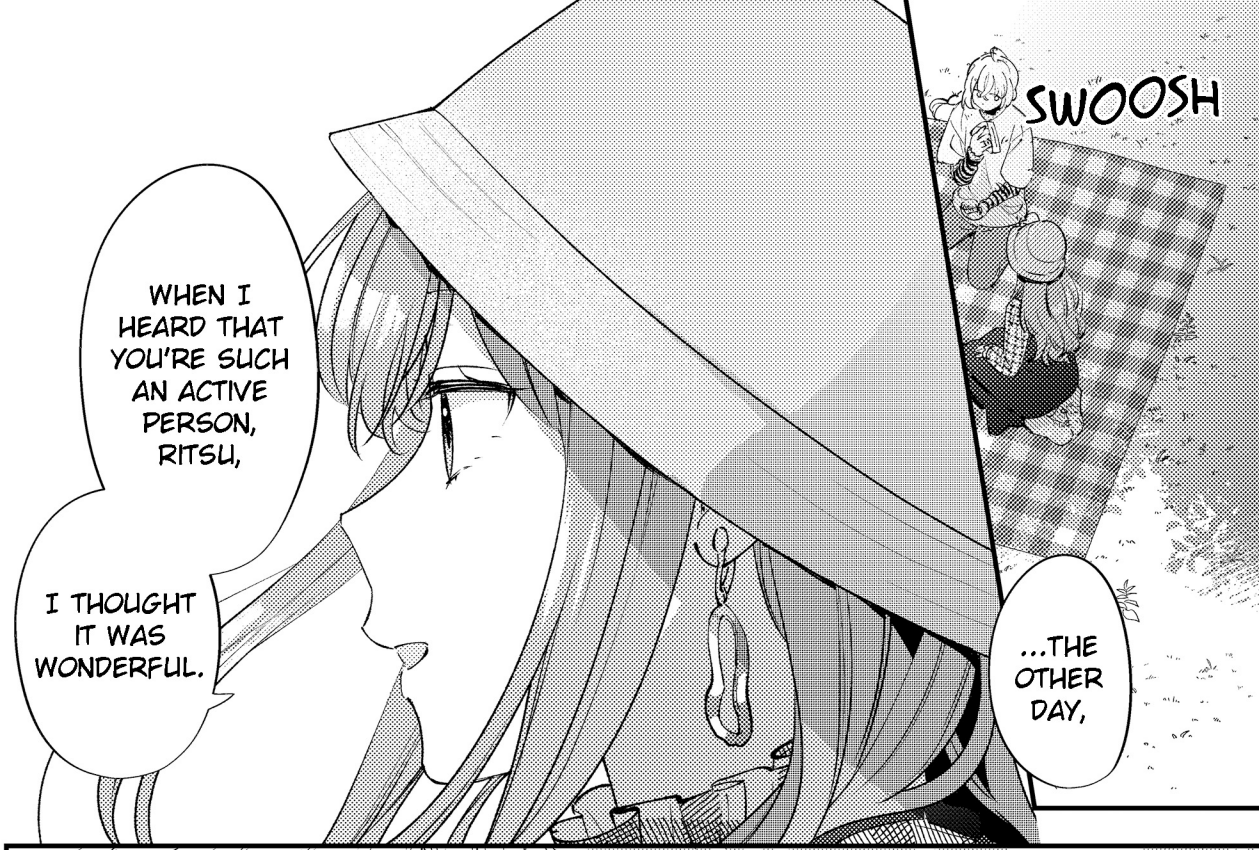

MM-HM.
REALLY?
MILK COFFEE CAFE

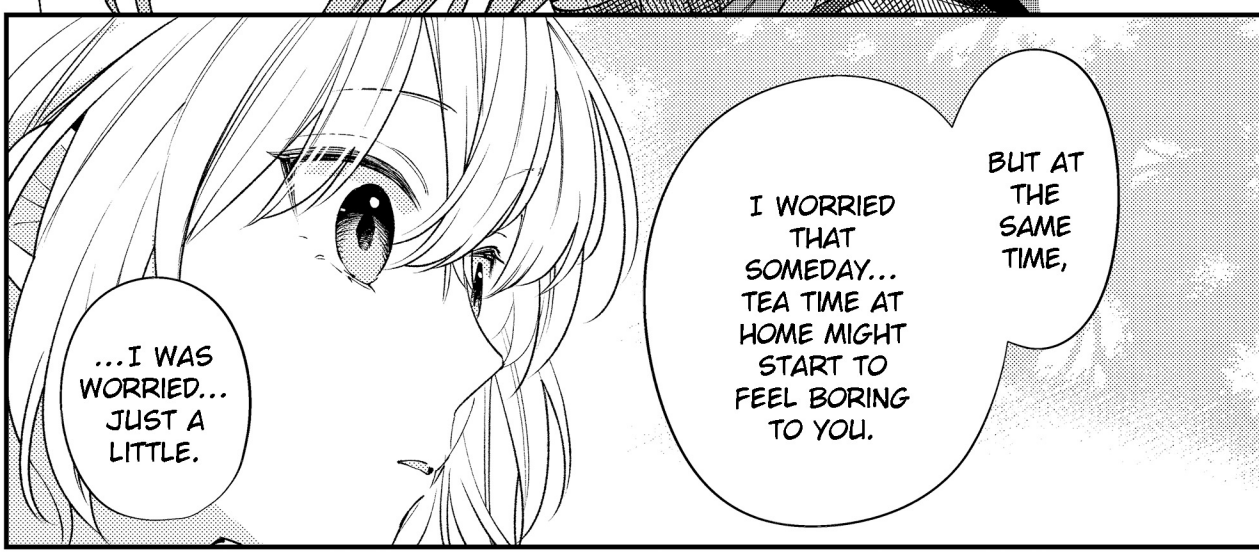

WE CAN FILL A BASKET WITH OUR FAVORITE SANDWICHES...
!!
LET'S GO ON A PICNIC AND HAVE TEA OUTSIDE!
THEN, NEXT TIME,
!

BREW TEA,
AND PLAN OUR NEXT OUTING WHILE WE DRINK!
YES! I'LL BRING CAKE TOO!

SHINE
SHI
WHAT A PERFECT DAY FOR A PICNIC!


THE SANDWICHES ARE DELICIOUS!
THE COOKIES YOU BAKED, RITSU, ARE AMAZING TOO.
WAKING UP EARLY WAS WORTH IT!
AFTER ALL,
TEA TIME OUTDOORS IS NICE TOO.
HAA...


SWOOSH
...THE OTHER DAY,
WHEN I HEARD THAT YOU'RE SUCH AN ACTIVE PERSON, RITSU,
I THOUGHT IT WAS WONDERFUL.


BUT AT THE SAME TIME,
I WORRIED THAT SOMEDAY... TEA TIME AT HOME MIGHT START TO FEEL BORING TO YOU.
...I WAS WORRIED... JUST A LITTLE.

IT DOESN'T HAVE TO BE EVERY DAY.
IT DOESN'T EVEN HAVE TO BE AT HOME.
ANYWHERE IS OKAY.
WOULD YOU DRINK TEA WITH ME AGAIN?

!
MY HAT–!
FWIP
OF COURSE–
RITSU—
I'LL GO GET IT!
DASH
RITSU—
THANK YOU.
CATCH

I...
MITSURUKO,
I'D NEVER FIND IT BORING.
I LOVE OUR TEA TIME TOGETHER.

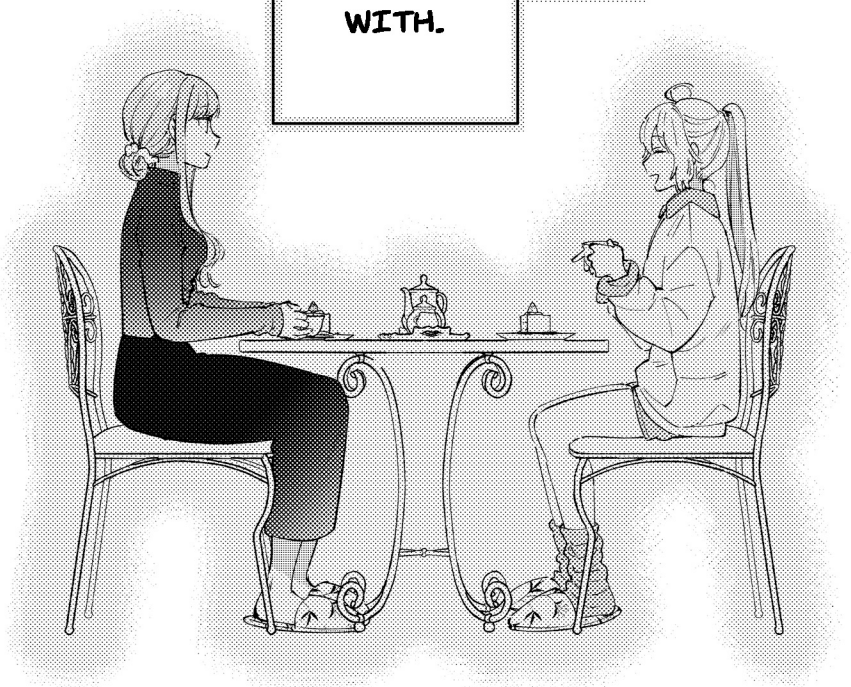
YOU MIGHT THINK OF ME,
AS YOUR "SAVIOR,"
OR THAT I'M JUST GOING ALONG WITH IT...
BUT THAT'S NOT HOW I FEEL AT ALL.
I JUST—
I THOUGHT IT WAS WONDERFUL.

THAT'S WHY I STARTED DRINKING TEA WITH YOU.
...ME TOO.

SHARING TEA WITH SOMEONE IS A WONDERFUL THING.
GRANDMOTHER...
I STILL DON'T WANT YOU TO DIE, BUT NOW,
ME TOO!
RITSU.

I HAVE SOMEONE I LIVE WITH,

TO SHARE TEA WITH.



AND IT'S NOT JUST TEA.

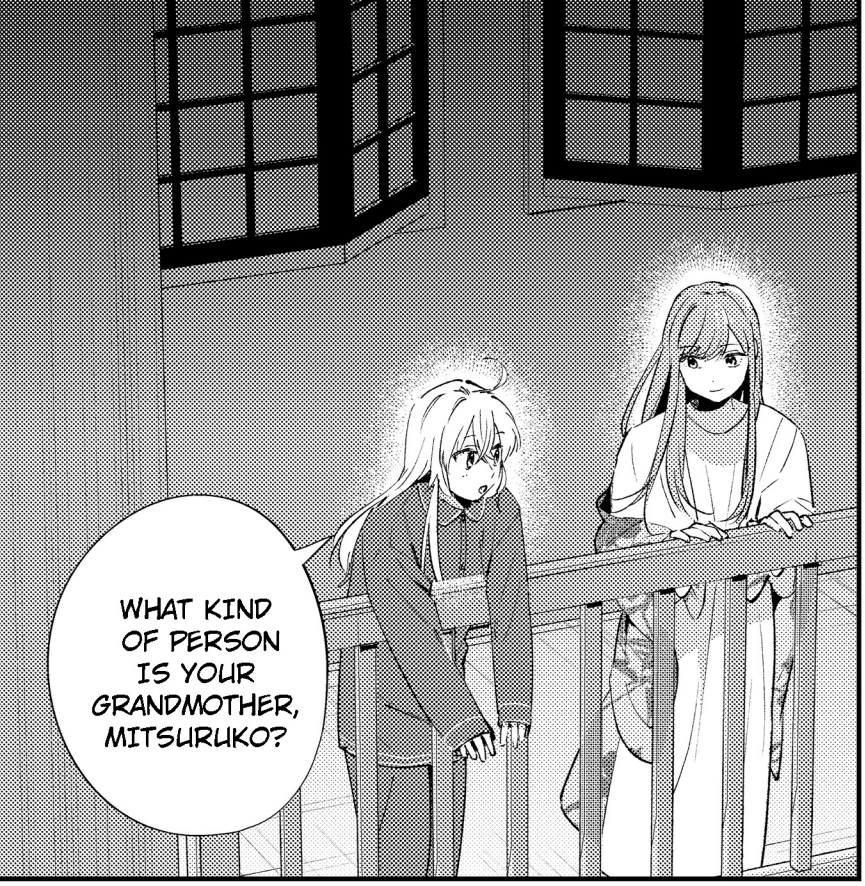
FROM NOW ON, RITSU AND I WILL SURELY

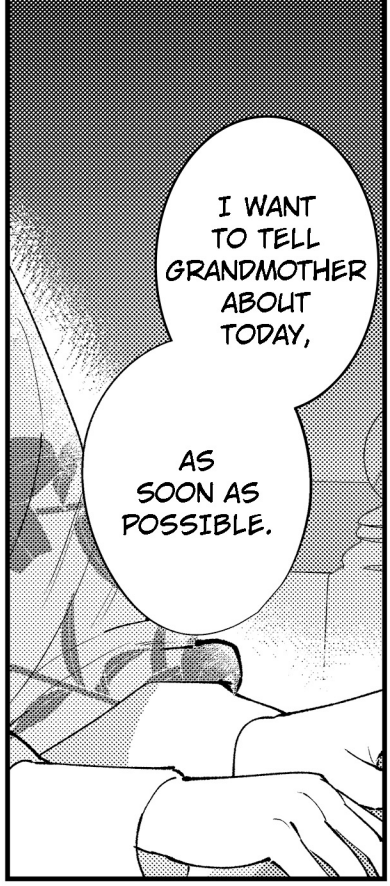
DO MANY THINGS TOGETHER,

SHARE MANY FEELINGS,

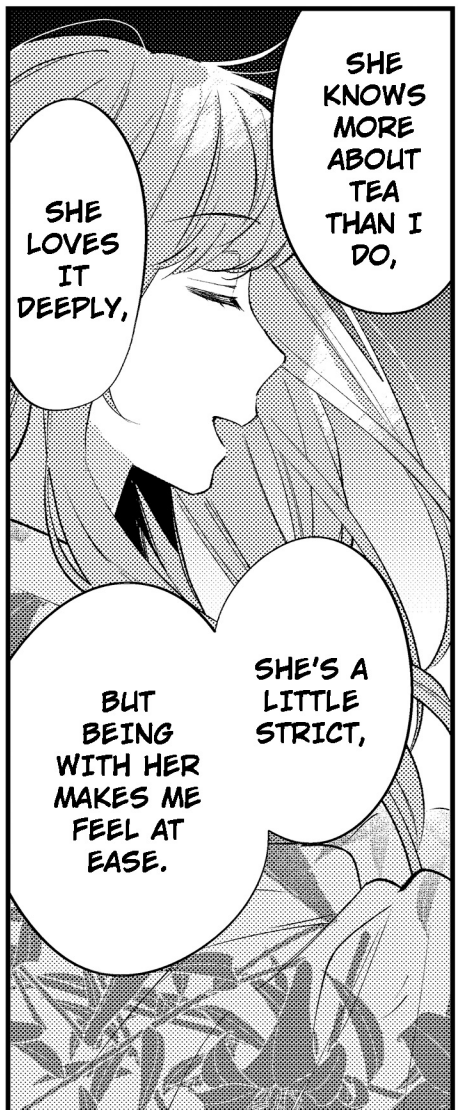
AND THAT, WITHOUT A DOUBT,

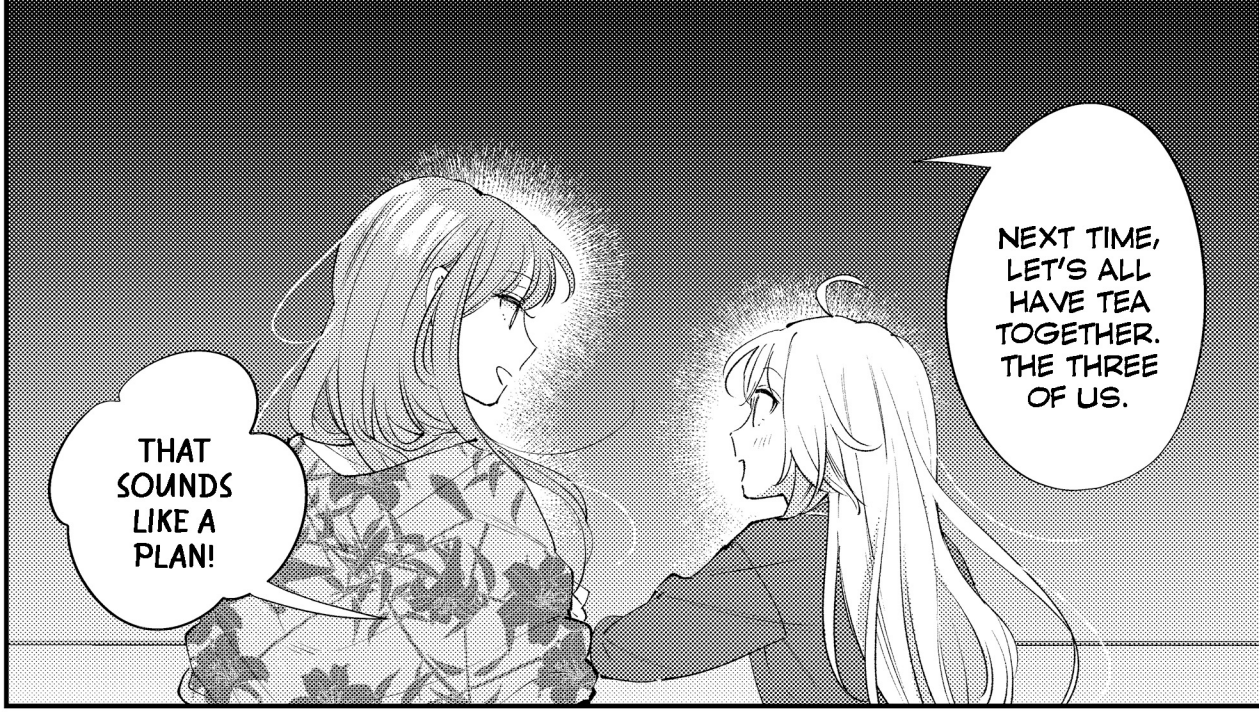
IS SOMETHING TRULY WONDERFUL.


WHAT KIND OF PERSON IS YOUR GRANDMOTHER, MITSURUKO?


I WANT TO TELL GRANDMOTHER ABOUT TODAY,
AS SOON AS POSSIBLE.

YOU REALLY LOVE YOUR GRANDMOTHER.


SHE KNOWS MORE ABOUT TEA THAN I DO,
SHE LOVES IT DEEPLY,
SHE'S A LITTLE STRICT,
BUT BEING WITH HER MAKES ME FEEL AT EASE.


NEXT TIME, LET'S ALL HAVE TEA TOGETHER. THE THREE OF US.
THAT SOUNDS LIKE A PLAN!

I WONDER IF SHE LIKES CAKE.
I'D LOVE FOR HER TO TRY THE CAKE I BAKE.
SHE'D LOVE IT.
LET'S HAVE HER TRY IT.

THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR READING!